

Problem 4. Tangkhul verbs

Solution:

Tangkhul verb forms:

All sentences in the first paragraph have ‘vaa-’ form common and their English translations also have the verb ‘go’ in common. So, let us assume, ‘vaa-’ = go. Then hayra = has past-participle of verb (as in has gone)

-ra = future (will)

-ya = present tense/ habitual

-ngaaya=want to

Further, lora = will buy. Thus, lo= buy.

raara = will come. Thus, raa = come. Then, -ka = let (me)

I= I, na=you. li= some case-marker such as ‘with’/ ‘to’.

vaashapra= can go. So, shapra =can. mashashapmara = cannot eat. mangaryaomana =do not play. So, ngaryao=play, ma—shapmara =cannot (better reasoning: ma--- ma--- =not, --shapra=can; that is, ma is a negative marker attaching to the verb as well as the tense/ aspect/mood suffix. This can be reasoned from the ‘do not play’ form, in which the verb is negated by prefixing ma, and adding mana.).

Thus, the solutions

are:

I ice-cream **shara**.

I hainathaiwi ice-cream **shahayra**.

I strawberrywi ice-cream **shangaaya**.

I aathaiyurlongaaya.

I ice-cream shaka.

I thangthangpinglora.

Na ithumlibazaarlimaraashapmara.